

THE OPENING SHOT.

A SPECIALTY COFFEE AUDIT JOURNAL — RESEARCHED, BREWED & DECODED BY HARISH
JANUARY — JULY 2026 · SINGAPORE · UBUD · MUMBAI · JOHOR BAHRU

Forty audits.
One benchmark.
Zero shortcuts.

What began as hurried notes at a Bali breakfast table is now a forty-entry technical archive: extraction physics, varietal genetics, and a three-phase sensory protocol applied to every cup. This issue decodes the first half of 2026 — the chemistry, the hardware, the benchmarks, and the palate that sharpened along the way.

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40

AUDITS

21

CAFÉS

15

ORIGINS

180

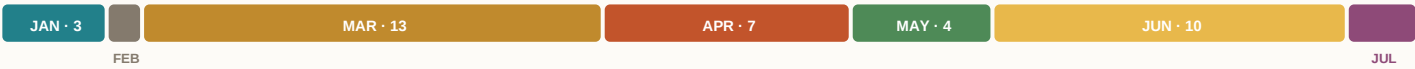
DAYS

SGD 265.95

SPEND

"Analyze the cup. Respect the bean. Log everything."

SESSION INTENSITY BY MONTH



JAN

The accidental beginning

UBUD, BALI

A family holiday and a Kintamani Natural ordered without ceremony. Three cups at Seniman later I was logging brew ratios at the breakfast table. The archive began before I had agreed to it — enthusiasm first, methodology arriving fast behind.

FEB

One cup, one signal

SINGAPORE

A single entry: Kenya Kiamugumo AA at Kyuukei. SL28/SL34, fully washed — phosphoric acid gripping the palate and staying. That persistence is genetic, not roast-made. A quiet month that taught me to read varietal signatures before roast character.

MAR

Thirteen audits, one apricot

MUMBAI + SINGAPORE

The volume month, and the personal one. Mumbai's anaerobics read polite; Singapore answered with conviction. At Narrative, Aanya tasted her first specialty filter — a Salvadoran Natural — and called 'apricot' unprompted. Sensory decode, age seven. Straight into the archive.

APR

The Holy Trinity closes

SINGAPORE + JOHOR

La Laja's washed Sudan Rume opened April with nectarine precision; a Panama Geisha followed at Lume in the rain; then Asylum's Peru Gesha completed the set — Gesha, Wush Wush, Sudan Rume, all washed, five weeks, unplanned. The month closed across the border at Hacienda La Florida in Johor: MYR 35, lime hot, plum cool, and my longest journey yet for a single extraction.

MAY

Nylon, four ways

SINGAPORE

Two days, four audits, one roaster. Opposing Brazils, an Ethiopia Banko Gotiti that travelled lemon → melon → white tea across the phases, and a Nicaraguan anaerobic that behaved like none of them. Five visits now — the most-audited café in the archive, and still not predictable.

JUN

The acceleration

SINGAPORE

Ten audits in nineteen days. The archive's first Liberica at Corner Corner — longan aromatics, vinyl on the walls. Then Sunday the 28th: Keryi at 10:30 for a Mosto Fermentation, Asylum by 11:06 for the Yellow Sudan Rume EF2. Two process firsts before noon. Field work at its finest.

JUL

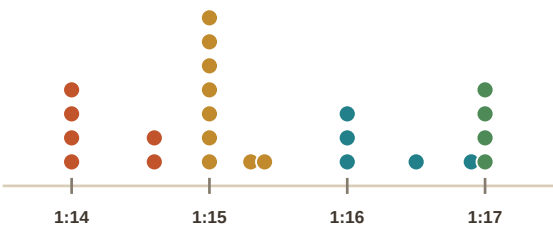
Closing the half

SINGAPORE

June 30 delivered the first Myanmar origin — and the first automated-tap cup, logged N/A because there was no brew event to record. July 1: Kyuukei's Worka Chelchele, a Gedeb landrace triad on a ramped 85→95°C profile. Forty entries. The ledger closes; the palate keeps calibrating.

THE RATIO CONSTELLATION

Every recorded brew ratio · each dot = one audit



MODE 1:15 · LEAN TAIL 1:17 · ONE ESPRESSO OUTLIER AT 1:2
14 of 40 unrecorded — barista-trust brews, logged honestly as Unknown

HARDWARE DNA — GRINDER CENSUS

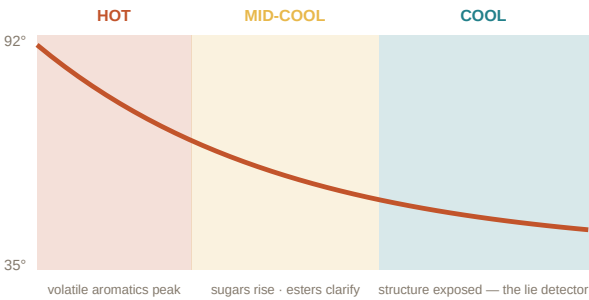


EXTRACTION PHYSICS — WHY FLAT BURRS WIN

Flat burrs shear; conicals crush. Shearing yields a narrower particle distribution — fewer boulders under-extracting sugars, fewer fines migrating to choke the bed. In sensory terms this is **clarity**: volatile acids and esters arrive as separate events rather than a smear. 95% of hardware-known audits this half ran flat burrs, and both of the half's weakest cups were conical-brewer drawdowns exhibiting fines-clogged citric flatness. Small dataset; unambiguous pattern.

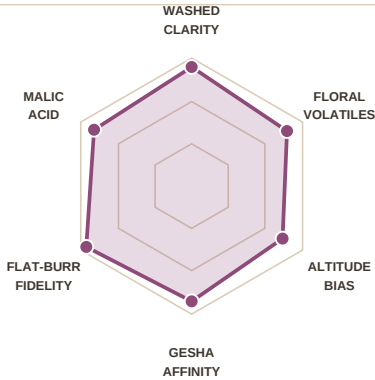
THE THREE-PHASE SENSORY PROTOCOL

Every audit tastes the cup three times as it cools.



A cup that only performs hot is hiding something. Mid-cool is where honest lots bloom; the cool phase is where defects surrender.

PALATE DNA — SIX AXES

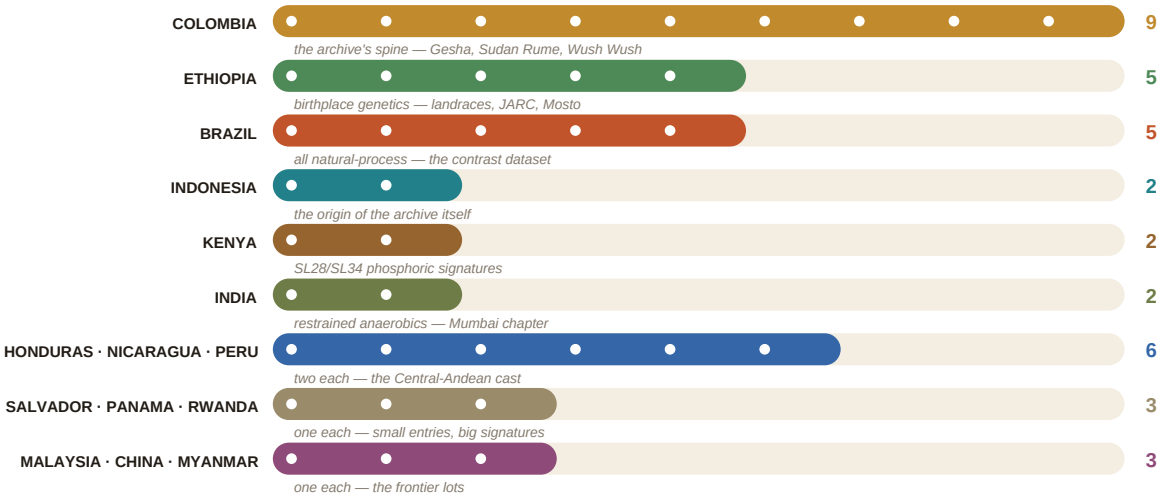


DOSE · YIELD · THERMAL PROTOCOLS

Standard dose	15 g
Yield window	190–277 g
Protocols seen	91–95°C · 91→78°C · 85→95°C ramp
The wildest	90–92° pours 1–2 → 68–70° pours 3–4

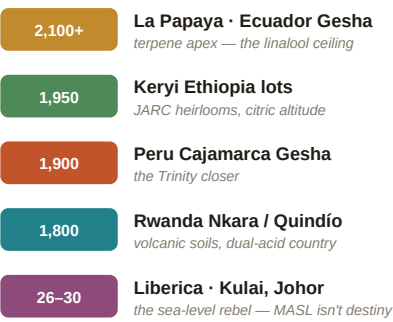
THE FREQUENCY TABLE

Audits per origin country · pips mark individual sessions



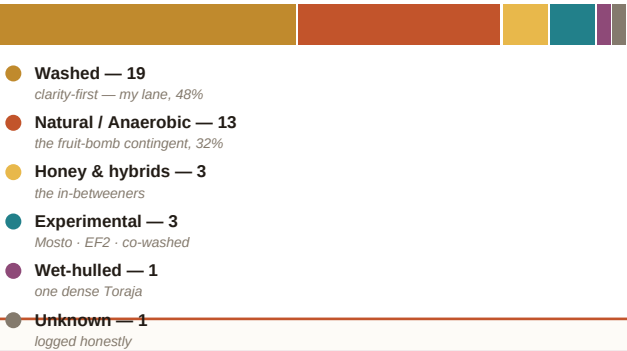
THE ALTITUDE LADDER

MASL predicts acid density — mostly.



THE PROCESS LEDGER

How the cherry was treated before it reached the bar.



FIELD NOTE — THE MYANMAR MOMENT

Audit #39 was a frontier twice over: the archive's first Myanmar origin — an Arakan Mountain Catimor — and its first automated batch-tap dispense. Pear-forward, almond edge, faithful to the roaster's notes... and thermally flat, because batch dispensing erases the brew event entirely. Parameters logged N/A — a format with nothing to record, not data gone missing. The atlas grows in unexpected directions.

Nº 1

ALL-TIME BENCHMARK

EL OBRAJE

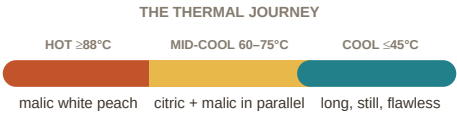
Fluid Collective · Potong Pasir

GREEN DATA

Washed Gesha · Cauca, Colombia · high-MASL lot

SENSORY DECODE

Most washed Colombians lead citric; El Obraje led **malic** — rounder, softer — then held both acids in parallel through the mid-cool window like harmony lines. The cool phase, my lie detector, found nothing to expose. A benchmark is not a score. It is the cup every later Gesha must answer to.



EXTRACTION PHYSICS

Hand pour-over, house recipe; integration this complete implies tight particle distribution — flat-burr uniformity legible in the cup.

Nº 2

VARIETAL REVELATION

LA LAJA — JAMES FERNANDEZ

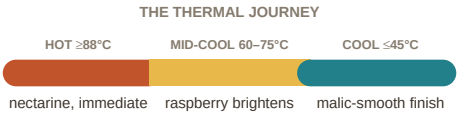
Maxi Coffee Bar · Club Street

GREEN DATA

Washed Sudan Rume · Cauca, Colombia · low-yield wild Ethiopian genetics

SENSORY DECODE

The first sip was not fruit-adjacent; it was **actually nectarine** — the specific fruit, not the category. Raspberry surfaced beneath, then the textbook dual-acid handoff: citric on the attack, malic closing. The first washed Sudan Rume in the archive, and the audit that set the Holy Trinity in motion.



EXTRACTION PHYSICS

SSP 78 mm flat burrs at 1:15 — precision hardware matched to a precision varietal; clarity earned at the farm and again at the grinder.

Nº 3

PROCESS MILESTONE

YELLOW SUDAN RUME EF2

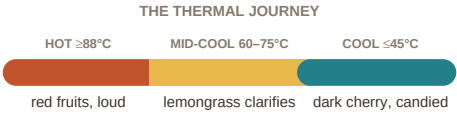
Asylum Coffeehouse · 28 June, 11:06

GREEN DATA

Yellow-mutation Sudan Rume · Pijiao, Quindío · Extended Fermentation Natural (EF2)

SENSORY DECODE

The second audit of the two-firsts morning. Extended fermentation prolongs what nature starts, and the phases behaved like three different coffees: red-fruit riot hot, herbal clarity mid, then concentrated dark cherry flirting with candy while never crossing into it. Processing as authorship — the producer's hand fully legible in the cup.



EXTRACTION PHYSICS

EF2 esters are thermally fragile — geraniol and lemongrass exist inside a ~15°C window; without three-phase tasting they simply go unmet.

Washed isn't boring. It's honest.

Forty audits kept confirming it: washed process is where terroir, genetics and altitude speak without a translator. A washed Gesha at 2,100 MASL tastes like the mountain. Naturals are fireworks; washed is the night sky behind them.

The conical problem is now data.

Two sessions, identical signature: V60 geometry, fines pooling at the drain, citric flatness, no thermal journey. The same coffee on a flat-bottom bed told a different story. Flat burrs, flat bottom — no longer a preference. A finding.

The best audits aren't about coffee.

Aanya's 'apricot' at Narrative — called before I said a word — outranks every technical note this half. She ordered a second cup at Asylum unprompted. The archive logs coffee; some rows log considerably more.

Logging rebuilt the palate.

January me tasted 'fruity'. July me tastes malic versus citric, clocks the barista's burrs before the menu, and waits for the mid-cool before judging. Forty cups turned enthusiasm into instrumentation. That is the real return on the archive.

THE ROAD AHEAD — BEYOND THE CITY

- Seed-to-cup at origin**
farm visits, cupping at source, harvest-season immersion — meeting the bean before the roaster does
- The world's finest cafés**
wherever they are — Tokyo's kissaten precision, Melbourne's roaster benches, and beyond
- Roastery residencies**
watching green become cup — profiling, sample roasting, production QC from the inside
- Eugenioides**
the near-mythical low-caffeine diploid — the rarest genetics still missing from the archive
- The exploration continues**
no matter where it leads — the archive travels with the palate now

H1 — THE LEDGER

Total documented spend	SGD 265.95
Average per audit	SGD 10.23
Cheapest cup	SGD 5.10 — Kyuukei Kenya
Priciest	MYR 35 (~SGD 11) — Johor
Most-audited café	Nylon — five sessions
Flat-burr share	95% of known hardware
Milk drinks in the audit	zero, and counting
Archive firsts logged	9 — species · process · format

UNTIL THE CLOSING SHOT

Issue 02 arrives at year-end. The Singapore chapter is written; the next one has no fixed address — origin farms, world-class bars, wherever the finest cups are poured. If you know one, tell me. The best audits in this issue all began as someone else's recommendation. — Harish, July 2026